

ense data in one place. The data points we are tracking, but are not limited to:

- Spend
- Engagement
- Conversion
- Sisense data

Sisense Sync {gitlab-reporting}

GitLab uses Sisense to track backend data such as MQLs and SAOs. GitLab shares this data with PMG through a data connection with Alli so PMG can use Datastudio to connect the front end campaign data with its back-end Sisense performance. The shared data in the dashboard is used to prepare full-funnel marketing reports and presentations.

Finance {finance}

Accruals {accruals}

Accruals are submitted to GitLab 3 business days before the end of the current month. In addition to the actual current monthly spend at the time accruals are due, PMG also includes estimated accruals based on the forecasted average daily spend. Digital Marketing must verify accruals 4-5 business days before the end of the month, making sure all Allocadia IDs/Coupa POs are correct and estimated spends are within range. Final accruals are then calculated based on effective media spend and PMG tech & agency fees. Note: fees change depending on the media spend tier.

Billing {billing}

Billing is submitted by the PMG Demand Gen team to the PMG Finance team within the first two business days of the new month. Billing is broken down into unique line items by the following:

- Team (i.e demand gen, field, abm, corporate marketing, etc.)
- Channel
- Region
- Campaign/Use Case

Invoicing {invoicing}

PMG sends separate invoices to GitLab by team initiatives or if specifically requested by GitLab marketing team. These invoices are sent in PDF files directly from PMG to the GitLab Marketing team via email.

SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/digital-strategy/digital-strategy-management/_index.md

Digital Strategy Team {digital-marketing-management}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Goals and Objectives {goals-objectives}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Team Charter:

Develop the digital strategy to drive INQ's and MQL's that lead to SAO's for GitLab full funnel campaigns across all segments and regions. Our core competency is to deliver a plan inclusive of the best digital channels in order to maximize the dollars and closely monitor campaigns and their assets for peak optimization.

Digital marketing managers own the INQ and MQL number that drive SAO's for the region and segment they align to. They are responsible for daily monitoring of campaign goals and the digital strategy component of that lightning strike. Their plans are representative across all funnel stages and each have unique channel expertise. The team is broken down as follows:

Joon Shin: SMB, MM, AMER, APAC, Auto-SD Test, team enablement, digital experience & All Remote

Zac Badgley: (parental leave through Nov so some assignments are TBD), ABM and Campaigns teams

In Scope:

End to end campaign management

Asset performance optimization

Daily/Weekly/Monthly/Quarterly reporting

Issue management

Agency liaison

Paid traffic conversion rate optimization

Out of scope:

Pure brand awareness

SEO

Ad creative

How Do We Get There?

We take a unified approach to long term planning. We are given our direction from the focal topics/areas that product marketing has deemed market worthy. They engage the campaigns team who pull us in to develop the key tenets of the campaign. Prior to a lightning strike kickoff call, we conduct research to validate campaign key terms, their effectiveness, and the addressable market for the various channels that comprise our digital marketing plans.

Upon agreement and alignment with the research findings, we develop a recommendation of the number of assets and asset types that are most effective in digital across all media types. We feed the core planning team this intelligence at the beginning of the campaign kickoff so that they can plan the asset creation and campaign accordingly. With these recommendations, we encourage the core team to consider whether or not assets already exist and simply need to be refaced or if they need to be developed/net-new. The SSoT for content is PathFactory and internal assets SSoT is HighSpot. The digital marketing team is not responsible for allocating budget to the creation of these assets however we will happily support applying budget to adjust an asset for improved performance in a digital channel. (ex. Asset size, color, etc).

This content creation must be baked into the overall planning timeline we review later on this page.

Once the types of assets are identified, the digital marketing issue should be created using the digital campaign request template in GitLab. Historically similar design requests and ad copy requests have been made by multiple teams so it's the teams hope that by placing this request at the beginning of the planning process will remove such instances of duplication.

While the digital marketing team would love to support any and all requests that are asked of us in support of the business, we have a finite budget and finite resources and will do our best to maximize both. Sub-region campaigns or campaigns to drive event attendance have proven ineffective in many historical cases and are an example of where we are currently unable to afford these low outcome campaigns.

Digital Campaign Planning Timeline

The digital marketing manager will need to be briefed on the campaign by the core team in advance of the kickoff call to define the "elevator pitch" for the campaign (ex. This campaign targets mid market IT Directors who need x pain point solved) so we can work with our agency to determine the market opportunity within digital and validate keywords across multiple channels to focus on. Understanding the source of this elevator pitch came from (i.e. market research, sales feedback, customer advisory board, etc) is important for the team to know when crafting their marketing plan recommendations. We expect this research (inclusive of competitive updates and options as well as campaign naming conventions) to take 2 weeks to return back to the digital team who will then share key learnings with the core planning team. At this point, we should be no sooner than 12 weeks prior to campaign launch.

T-12 weeks to campaign launch:

Understand proposed campaign assets, their status and who is creating them

Digital team to develop the media plan, their goals, the channel mix, spend, keyword list, and campaign calls to action

T-10 weeks to campaign launch:

Tracking pixels, landing pages developed (digital experience team) with input from digital marketing team

UTM parameters created by campaigns team. URL's created.

T-8 weeks to campaign launch:

Freeze all changes to campaign scope and targets. No further changes or launch date with slip.

T-6 weeks to campaign launch:

Digital marketing team should have possession of all assets for build out.

T-4 weeks to campaign launch:

Assets are loaded for campaign set up/build out.

T-2 weeks to campaign launch:

Test leads entered, tracked and final campaign adjustments complete. Ready for launch.

Using GitLab: Digital Marketing Project

Labels {labels}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Note: Some of the following labels only exist on the Digital Marketing project level.

Digital Marketing Programs: General label to track all issues related to Digital Marketing

SEM: Used for issues that require organic and paid search initiatives

Paid Ads: Used for any paid advertising campaign such as Google Ads

Paid Social: Used for paid social campaigns such as LinkedIn and Facebook Ads

mktg-demandgen - Demand Gen general, add since we are part of the Demand Gen team

mktg-digitalmarketing - Digital Marketing general, issues specific to Digital Marketing only

Slack channels {slack}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

digital-marketing: General digital marketing conversation and questions

integrated-marketing: For the wider Integrated Marketing team, to share and discuss issues, projects, trainings, and resources that connect the Digital, Campaigns, Field, and Partner Marketing departments.

Paid Digital Marketing {paid-digital-marketing}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

How does paid digital contribute to GitLab's funnel? {funnel}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Top of Funnel (Awareness): Introduce GitLab brand to potential customers with awareness and educational content.

Middle of Funnel (Consideration): Nurturing engaged prospects with solutions-based assets, consideration-stage content and events.

Bottom of Funnel (Conversion): Leading prospects to conversion by retargeting with relevant down-funnel content and demo/free trial.

Click [here](#) to see channel definitions and where they fit in buyer journey.

The Digital Marketing team's strategy & execution ultimately leads to filling pipeline, while closely analyzing down-funnel metrics & results in order to influence & optimize top of funnel strategy in a feedback loop.

External Agencies {agency}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

We work with external agencies to help support campaign execution including competitive research, media buys, campaign optimization and reporting. GitLab is responsible for campaign set up and monthly and quarterly read outs to our core planning team members.

GitLab Digital Marketing works directly with agencies within the GitLab Digital Advertising

project, which is strictly for Digital Marketing & agency communication only.

For more detailed information on our partnership, communication, and invoicing, please see our handbook page.

Quarterly planning and strategy creation

We don't invest in assets, we invest in campaigns. We need to understand the campaign's objectives and goals. We triage each request and analyze and with the required information to develop a point of view as to what we can reasonably do with the dollars we have.

We need to understand the buyer persona we are targeting, the segment and the region and with that information, develop a point of view that determines what's possible.

The segment and regional goals are built from the TOPO model so everything we do, maps back to that. The goals we align to, add up to the ultimate goal so if we get there through campaign A or B is irrelevant. We need to get there in the most efficient way possible.

By monitoring these campaigns regularly we'll be able to dial up and dial down the investment to make sure we are getting maximum performance. We are laser focused on driving high volume balanced with high quality, so if an asset is not performing, we take it down, right away. If it's exceeding expectations, we put more money behind it. We need to be able to shift on a dime and have developed criteria and a process for evaluating these assets.

Each sales segment and region have varying ASP's and average sales cycles - those are taken into consideration as we set the goals for the campaign and as we begin to track results. For a campaign that has just gone live, we need to be sure to set the expectation upfront about when we will start to see results and will they come in the form of INQ's, MQL's or SAO's. By setting the expectations in advance, we can track to those goals and keep all pertinent teams apprised of results.

Finally, each campaign will have an end date that will prompt further discussion and evaluation. The end date is determined at the time of issue creation and should not exceed 6 months. Assets will be consistently evaluated for effectiveness, need for refresh or revision.

Partnering with Other Important GitLab Teams

We need to have connection points into and from other teams. Our team sees this engagement as catch and release.

Catch: Who are we catching info from - who do we need insight from to understand what they are doing, why they are doing it and how it might factor into the work we do?

ABM (understanding who is being targeted so we can omit from digital marketing efforts) - Zac

Campaigns - Zac

Customer References - TBD

PR - TBD

Digital experience - Joon

All remote team - Joon

Brand strategy - Sara

Visual brand- Sara

Release: Which GitLab teams should have visibility into the campaigns we are running in an effort to align messages or understand how the public is responding to campaigns.

ABM: sharing the content we are using in segments and regions for awareness purposes.

Field marketing

Channel marketing

Alliances marketing

MS&P

Digital Campaign Channels {campaign-channels}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

(incomplete list)

Digital Marketing will recommend specific channels based on your campaign goals. The most common type is Paid Social based on robust targeting criteria and successful performance in reach and inquiry volume.

Channels {channels}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Paid Social

LinkedIn - Sponsored Content Ads, Carousel Ads, InMail/Message Ads, and Conversation Ads

~~Facebook - Single Image & Video Ads, Lead Generation Ads, Carousel Ads~~

Instagram - Single Image & Video Ads, Lead Generation Ads, Carousel Ads

Twitter - Promoted Tweets, Image or Video

YouTube - Video Ads

Paid Search

Google - Expanded Text Ads, Responsive Search Ads

Bing - Expanded Text Ads, Responsive Search Ads

Paid Display

GDN (Google Display Network) - Display Image Ads, Responsive Display Ads

DV360 (Google Display & Video 360) - Programmatic Display Image Ads, Responsive Display Ads,

Access to private ad networks

6sense is a digital marketing platform for Display only, mainly used to target specific accounts. Please note that 6sense is managed by the ABM team, partnering with 6sense directly.

Please contact the ABM team (focuses on Tier 1,2,3 accounts) if you would like to create a 6sense campaign, or check out the 6sense page for more info.

BuySellAds

Sponsorships (Publisher Engagements):

Participating in Virtual Event (Virtual Conference, Panel, Talking Head, All-Day

Event/Summit)

Third Party Custom Webcasts (single & multi-vendor)

Newsletter ads

Custom email blasts

Sponsored Custom & 3rd Party Content Creation (trend reports, ebooks, articles, etc.)

General third party event sponsorships

Podcasts

Site Display Ads

Microsites
Content Syndication

Channel definitions {channel-definitions}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Paid Social {paid-social}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Paid social ads are sponsored ads that we show on social platforms. The three social media platforms that we primarily advertise on are Facebook/Instagram, LinkedIn (including LinkedIn InMail & Conversation Ads), and Twitter. LinkedIn is our top platform in general due to its firmographic targeting, allowing us to target more effectively toward specific segments & job criteria.

Best used for: Top and mid funnel content. Does well for both awareness and direct response (depending on the asset used). LinkedIn InMail and Conversation ads stand out as more mid and bottom funnel.

Best type of content to use: Live webcasts, recorded webcasts, events, and ebooks/guides. Live events with a sign-up deadline, tend to perform the best in paid social.

Worst type of content to use: Thought leadership reports/whitepapers like Gartner and Forrester reports.

Types of targeting we do:

Prospecting targeting: Sponsored ads to audiences that are built based on personas using interest, professional, and demographic targeting. A profile is developed based on people who convert. We would then show ads to people natively within either Facebook, Instagram or LinkedIn that closely match that profile. This method helps drive new traffic to GitLab that may not know about the brand or product.

Account targeting: Sponsored ads on targeting specific accounts or contacts based on a list upload or import from Marketo. LinkedIn is the top channel for this type of marketing based on a +90% account match rate, whereas Facebook and Instagram requires accounts to be manually entered in order to target.

Retargeting: Re-engage people who have already visited pages on the GitLab website, engaged with GitLab content, or are currently within our nurture. Note: It's necessary to have a large audience for this tactic to be successful due to email match rates within the platforms.

Paid Search {paid-search}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

As people are researching or exploring keywords relevant to GitLab, we used Google AdWords to promote responsive search ads on the Google search engine to drive people to specific GitLab landing pages. We do this by bidding on targeted keywords and phrases based on the assumed intent of the person, triggering the ad relevant to a specific user search query, and leading users to a related landing page that matches that intent.

Best used for: Brand campaigns for general exposure & building website visitor audiences, but also mid and bottom funnel content where we want someone to take action (ex: filling out a form

to a gated asset, signing up for a demo, etc).

Best type of content to use: Homepage and solutions pages for Brand campaigns, also use case gated assets that directly apply to the intent for the search query. How-to guides and ebooks do well here.

Worst type of content to use: Events and thought leadership reports/whitepapers like Gartner and Forrester reports that are not specifically tied to the intent of a search query. Caveat here is if the content is more of a how to report or guide.

Targeting: Paid Search is neither able to target by company size/segments nor by domain or company name. While this channel is best used for brand campaigns, non-brand campaigns also work well for specific research intent.

Retargeting: Re-engage people who have already visited pages on the GitLab website, engaged with GitLab content, or are currently within our nurture. While the retargeting reach is lower within AdWords compared to Paid Social channels, the user intent & continued research within the audience leads to high conversion rates down-funnel.

Paid Display {paid-display}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Display ads are banner ads that we mostly run are through the Google Display Network (GDN). GDN will show banner ads on websites that have Google AdSense set up on their website. There are no specific websites we show banner ads on - we earn the ad space by bidding on placements based on specific targeting criteria such as demographics, topics, and interests. On occasion, we run banner ads on specific websites through direct buys, but this is handled more in the publisher program.

Best used for: Top and mid funnel content. More used for awareness and some action-based response.

Best type of content to use: How-to guides, ebooks, and general awareness content promotion do well here. Trial ads tend to do well if used in some form of remarketing strategy.

Worst type of content to use: Events and thought leadership reports/whitepapers like Gartner and Forrester reports. Because there is a learning period when running Display advertising, running events through Display advertising is not recommended due to the short promotion period. With leadership reports/whitepapers, we historically have not seen good engagement and sign-ups for these types of assets on Display advertising.

Types of targeting we do:

Contextual targeting: Show banners ads on websites that are related to the content of our landing page and website. This is done based on keyword and topic targeting.

Prospecting targeting: Show banner ads to related audiences that are similar to those who have converted on our website. A profile is developed based on people who convert. We would then show banner ads to people that closely match that profile. This method helps drive new traffic to GitLab that may not know about the brand or product.

Retargeting: Re-engage people who have already visited pages on the GitLab website, engaged with GitLab content, or are currently within our nurture. This tactic can show ads on what seems to be irrelevant websites. However, targeting is based on the engagement of the person, not the context of a website.

Publisher Sponsorships {publisher-sponsorships}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Publisher sponsorships are when we engage a specific publisher in order to purchase placement on their web properties. Generally, we make sure the publisher's website(s) and audience closely match the profile of who we want to advertise to before engaging with the publisher. Sponsorships are less turn key than our other programs - while they require longer planning and execution, heavier lifts in content creation, and manual reporting, the long investment results in more qualified leads that are aligned with our goals & target audience.

Best used for: Primarily used for demand generation, so we focus on mid to bottom funnel content.

Best type of content to use: Live webcasts and recorded webcasts work the best. Ebooks and guides sometimes work, depending on the placement.

Worst type of content to use: Events and thought leadership reports/whitepapers like Gartner and Forrester reports. With leadership reports/whitepapers, we historically have not seen good engagement and sign-ups for these types of assets on Paid Social, unless the report is more of a how-to guide.

Steps to set up Content Syndication in Marketo & SFDC.

Project Managing Publisher Activities:

PMG will create an issue to contract with Publishers. It is important to add specific filtering for all programs (region, personas, country limits, etc.)

Once under contract, create an epic in the marketing project (epic code template) and the additional issues program tracking and list clean upload and relate them to the epic. Follow instructions for the remaining issues.

Assign program tracking issue to the Campaign Manager that supports the region and assign the list clean upload issue to Jameson

Once the leads are received, you should process them and submit them to MOPs in 24-48 hours

Reporting

Our key stakeholders for ongoing reporting include:

Campaigns teams and product marketing

GEO Sales leadership

IM Leadership

It is important to work through the digital marketing team for your paid media reporting requests as we have significant challenges that are currently being addressed. Please do not pull your own dashboard data, the output is very familiar to us and we want to be sure our stakeholders are pulling the right information, in the right format for ultimate accuracy.

We will also provide insight into asset specific performance and what we should expect from an asset should that differ greatly from the goals that are set. This should prompt an open and collaborative discussion.

Finance {finance}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Allocadia {allocadia}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Allocadia is the single source of truth for Digital Marketing's planned and forecasted budget throughout the fiscal year.

Monthly Process

Each month's forecast is locked around the middle of the current month, so Digital will confirm planned budgets by this date and also update the forecast based on shifts between certain line items. We monitor the Pipeline X-ray report to find gaps in coverage for specific regions & segments, so if we see a shortage in the current quarter's pipeline, we can strategically reallocate funds to ultimately generate more inquiries & MQLs for the region(s) or segment(s) that need it most. For example, if we are not utilizing our full Publisher budget for the month, we can move the remaining budget into LinkedIn for the Enterprise segment within the APAC region if it's experiencing low pipeline.

Once our monthly plan is locked in Allocadia, Digital will review their tab in the monthly Marketing AvB file for any further changes necessary before the end of the month.

Quarterly Process

Each quarter's plan is locked in Allocadia at least 2-3 days before the next quarter.

Since our budget is originally planned to accommodate our quarterly goals, we need to reconcile spend with Allocadia every month to make sure we are on pace to spend our planned budget. Since budget is strictly fluid within the quarter, Finance will alert Digital Marketing if we are pacing behind budget for a quarter in case we need to redistribute those funds.

Accruals & Invoices {accruals-invoices}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Due at least 4-5 business days before the end of the month, Digital Marketing works closely with PMG to prepare accruals (estimated billing amounts) for end of the month. Aside from the core Digital campaigns, PMG will notate which department (such as Field Marketing, ABM, Corporate, etc) is responsible for accrued spend, and Digital Marketing will verify the Allocadia IDs and Coupa POs related to each line item.

Once the month has ended, PMG will update the accruals sheet with actuals (final invoice amounts) with related invoice numbers, and there is typically a small buffer between estimated accruals & actuals. PMG will email PDF invoices to Digital Marketing and GitLab Accounting, automatically pushing invoices into Coupa for approval. Digital Marketing will verify that invoices are 1:1 match with actuals in the accrual sheet, then approve the invoices in Coupa.

For information on the Financial Planning processes & timelines for Digital Marketing, please follow the Marketing Finance handbook page.

Digital Campaign Ad Specs {specs}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Each paid channel has its own unique design specifications, ad copy character limits, and recommendations for their ad types to ensure ads can run at their optimal performance. If you do not yet have creative assets secured for your campaign, the design team can use this section as their guide when producing your creative. The standard requests for paid social images based on PMG recommendations are 1080x1920px, 1080x1080px, and 628x1200px.

Paid Social {social-specs}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

LinkedIn Image (Sponsored Content):

Text recommendations

Headline: 70 characters

Intro: 150 characters

Technical Requirements

Horizontal/Landscape

delivers to both desktop/mobile

Min: 640x360px

Max: 7680x4320px

Recommended: 1.91:1 - 1200x628

Square

delivers to both desktop/mobile

Min: 360x360px

Max: 4320x4320px

Recommended: 1:1 - 1200x1200px

Vertical

best for mobile (no deliver to desktop)

Min: 360x640px

Max: 1254x2400px

Recommended: 1.91:1 - 628x1200px

Recommended Image File Type: JPG or PNG

Recommended Image File Size: 5MB Max

Recommend using shorter copy within image, and lean on the headline/introduction text to convey more of your message

LinkedIn Video:

Text recommendations

Headline: 70 characters (200 max)

Intro: 150 characters (600 max)

Recommended Video Length: Less than 15 seconds

Recommended Video File Size: 75 KB to 200 MB

Recommended Video File Format: MP4

Minimum width: 360 pixels

Maximum width: 1920 pixels

Minimum height: 360 pixels

Maximum height: 1920 pixels

LinkedIn Carousel

Recommended Resolution: 1080x1080 pixels

Recommended Image File Type: JPG or PNG

Recommended Ratio: 1:1

Number of Carousel Cards: 2 to 10

Image Maximum File Size: 10MB

Video not supported currently

Copy: Primary Text: 150 character limit

Card: 45-character limit for carousel ads that direct to a destination URL

Copy: 30-character limit for carousel ads with a Lead Gen Form CTA

LinkedIn Conversation Ads

Twitter Image:

Recommended Image Size: 1200x675 pixels

Recommended Image Ratio: 1:1

Recommend using shorter copy within image, and lean on the headline/introduction text to convey more of your message

Copy: Primary Text: 280 character limit

Copy: Headline: 70 character limit

Twitter Video:

Recommended Video Size: 1200x1200

Recommended Video Ratio: 1:1

Recommended Video Length: less than 15 seconds

Recommended Branding: Consistent in upper left-hand corner

Recommended Video File Type: MP4 or MOV

Recommended Video File Size: 1GB Max

Copy: Primary Text: 280 character limit

Copy: Headline: 70 character limit

Paid Display (Google Display Network) {display-specs}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Regular Display Ad Sizes

160x600 pixels

250x250 pixels

300x1050 pixels

300x250 pixels

300x600 pixels

320x50 pixels

336x280 pixels

728x90 pixels

970x250 pixels

Responsive Display Ad Sizes (up to 15 images per ad)

1200x628 pixels

600x600 pixels

Responsive Display Logo Sizes (up to 5 logos per ad)

1200x300 pixels

1200x1200 pixels

Recommended Image File Type: JPG or PNG

Recommended Image File Size: 150KB Max

In-Banner Design High Performers

Benefit/Value Prop and educational messaging

CICD emblem background

"Learn More" CTA

4-7 word volume

Paid Search {search-specs}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

Responsive Search Ads

Copy: Description: 90 character limit, up to 4 options per ad

Copy: Headline: 30 character limit, up to 15 options per ad

Copy: Display URL path: 15 character limit, up to 2 per ad

UTMs for URL tagging and tracking {utm-tracking}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

All URLs that are promoted on external sites and through email must use UTM URL tagging to increase the data cleanliness in Google Analytics and ensure marketing campaigns are correctly attributed.

We don't use UTMs for internal links. UTM data sets attribution for visitors, so if we use UTMs on internal links it resets everything when the clicked URL loads. This breaks reporting for paid advertising and organic visitors.

You can access our internal URL tagging tool in Google Sheets. You will also find details in this spreadsheet on what "Campaign Medium" to use for each URL. If you need a new campaign medium, please check with the Digital Marketing Programs team as new mediums will not automatically be attributed correctly.

If you are not sure if a link needs a UTM, please speak with the marketer who is managing your campaign to ensure you are not interrupting the reporting structure they have in place.

UTM construction best practices:

lowercase only, not camelcase

alphanumeric characters only

no spaces

Campaign Medium covers general buckets like paidsearch, social, or sponsorship

Campaign Source names where the link lives. Examples include ebook, twitter, or qr code

Campaign Name describes a specific campaign. Try to add additional context like reinvent, forrester, and bugbounty

Campaign Content differentiates ad types.

Campaign Term identifies keywords used in a campaign

Opt-Out of Seeing GitLab Digital Ads {opt-out-ads}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE THIS ANCHOR -->

We run digital ads on the following channels:

Google (paid search and display)

Facebook

LinkedIn

Twitter

Demandbase (paid display)

Because everyone at GitLab works remotely, it makes it difficult to restrict ads from being shown to GitLab team members. In a brick and mortar environment, we can easily block IP addresses to accomplish this. Because everyone at GitLab has a different IP address, and even dynamic IP addresses, there is no way to implement an exclusion rule that would block all GitLab ads to GitLab team members.

If you would not like to see GitLab ads, you are able to opt-out of ads as you see them. Below is the process to remove GitLab ads. Please note that if you use both your personal and work accounts on your devices, you will need to exclude from both your personal and work accounts.

Google Paid Search: When you see a GitLab text ad in Google search engine results

1. On the ad, click on the arrow next to the URL
2. Click on Why this ad?
3. On the toggle next to "Show ads from gitlab.com", toggle off
4. Close out of box

Google Display: When you see a GitLab ad on a third-party website

1. Click on the blue arrow icon at the top right-hand corner for the ad
2. Select "Stop seeing this ad" when the option appears
3. Make a selection on why you do not want to see the ad anymore
4. Done

Facebook: When you see a GitLab ad on Facebook

1. On the upper right-hand corner of the ad, click the three dots in that corner
2. When menu appears, click on "Why am I seeing this ad?"
3. In the next pop-up box, under "What You Can Do", click the "Hide" button next to the option that says "Hide all ads from this advertiser"

LinkedIn: When you see a GitLab ad on LinkedIn

1. On the upper right-hand corner of the ad, click the three dots in that corner
2. When option box appears, click on "Report this ad, I don't want to see this ad in my feed"
3. In the pop-up box that appears next, select an option
4. Click the Submit button on the next page

Twitter: When you see a GitLab ad on Twitter

1. On the upper right-hand corner of the ad, click the arrow
2. When option box appears, click on "I don't like this ad"

Note that this does not necessarily block all ads, just that specific ad. You would need to do this on all the ads you see from GitLab

You could block @gitlab in your profile to no longer see ads. However you block all ability to engage with the @gitlab Twitter accounts as well (seeing Tweets, Retweeting, mentioning, etc).

Localization

Localization is a core tenet of the campaign managers GANTT chart that serves to manage the campaign and the digital team will do our best to support localization if we can ensure it doesn't severely impact campaign efficiency. Future versions of our investment model will contain a workback formula to help us evaluate whether or not localization would be effective, and affordable.

SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/digital-strategy/digital-strategy-management/changes-of-note.md

What is a change of note?

We need to keep track of instances where we make a change that can impact fundamental reporting, or change the behavior of a system we rely on to deliver campaigns.

This page collects those changes so we can quickly triangulate which change caused an issue that started on a certain day, or with certain behavior.

Google Tag Manager

11 June 2020 · Revamped event structure to take full advantage of Google Analytics 360

13 September 2019 - Added Bing Ads conversion tracking tags.

9 September 2019 - Added second Facebook pixel to match new Business Manager account managed by PMG. We will need to remove old pixel after completed transition.

7 August 2019 - Added Snowplow script to about.gitlab.com.

24 June 2019 · Added ClientID custom dimension to Google Analytics.

19 June 2019 · Added Pendo tag.

18 June 2019 · Added LinkedIn tags to track conversions.

17 June 2019 · Removed Rollworks tag.

14 June 2019 · Added Facebook tags to track conversions.

21 May 2019 · Discovered using Window Loaded caused some visitors landing page to record as (not set). Changed Google Pageview tag to fire with DOM Ready to correct problem introduced with Window Loaded, while still recording tags from blog posts.

10 April 2019 · Added Rollworks tag.

27 March 2019 · Added DemandBase tag.

8 February 2019 · Set Google Pageview tag to fire with Window Loaded event to populate the dataLayer with tags from blog posts.

20 December 2018 · Deployed updated GitLab Google Tag Manager container with new tag system.

SECTION: marketing/integrated-marketing/digital-strategy/social-marketing/_index.md

{{% alert title=" Welcome to the Social Marketing Handbook" color="info" %}}

The social marketing team is responsible for the stewardship of the GitLab brand social channels. We're accountable for the organic editorial calendar and work with partners across the Developer Relations, digital marketing, talent brand, and other teams to orchestrate the social media landscape for GitLab.

{{% /alert %}}

Social Marketing Handbook Pages

Admin and Project Management

Community Management

Social Reporting

Take a Social Training

Team Member Social Policy

Team Member Advocacy

Advocacy Curators

Contact the Social Marketing Team

Message us in the socialmediaaction Slack Channel

Current Major Project Links

Brand Campaigns

Brand Refresh

GitLab 15

Social Community Contributor

Events

KubeCon EU 2022

REMOTE by GitLab event 2022

GitLab Commit 2022

AWS reInvent 2022

Talent Brand

FY23 Social Talent Brand

Other Campaigns

2022 DevSecOps Survey
2022 Remote Playbook
2022 Remote Work Report

Long term Social Media Strategy (Over the next 3-5 years)

The Social Marketing Team is working towards a long term strategy that includes three major pillars. Each pillar would require dedicated resources to grow and flourish.

<details><summary>Brand</summary>

GitLab's company profiles on core social channels like Twitter and LinkedIn

-
 - Calendaring (Copy + Creative)
-
 - Crisis Response/Mitigation
-
 - Core reporting and analysis
-
 - Community Management
-
 - Partnering with Talent Brand for employer campaigns

</details>

<details><summary>Advocacy</summary>

Enabling GitLab's team members to publish GitLab-related content on their personal social media channels

-
 - Copy + Creative
-
 - Includes Comms, sales, talent brand
-
 - Core reporting and analysis

</details>

<details><summary>Institutional Listening</summary>

Data analysis to inform future campaigns, slogans, comms, as well as, competitive research

-
 - General Social Listening
-
 - Antemortem research for any and all marketing and comms
-
 - Insights inform all decisions

</details>

Strategic direction

Organic social is a two way communication system. It's about community and conversations. We can to appeal to the emotions of our audience through real-time conversations and interactions.

{{% alert color="success" %}}

We want:

-
 people to feel good.
-
 to embrace our community.

 to create excitement for the product.
{{% /alert %}}

Elevate our brand · - Increase team member community and sense of belonging. Less is more, particularly when it is executed well and resembles a world class brand.

"Inside out culture" · - Exercising our internal values to our external audiences.

No hard selling · - We throw softballs only.

FY23 OKRs

Check out the FY23 OKR Epic here

FY23 Content Strategy

The FY23 content strategy will enable our objectives of engagement and elevation.

Engagement

Because engagement is our principal metric focus, it's important that we consider all social content for engagement opportunities. Our reporting handbook page defines engagement and engagement rate:

{{% alert title="· Engagements" color="info" %}}

Are the number of times that users took action on our posts during the reporting period. This includes likes, retweets, comments, saves, replies, reactions, and shares. Does not include quote retweets.

{{% /alert %}}

{{% alert title="· Engagement Rate" color="info" %}}

Is the number of times during a reporting period that users engaged with our posts as a percentage of impressions. This metric indicates how engaging particular content or campaigns are overall.

{{% /alert %}}

Content for organic social media should inherently be engaging to our audiences. Content should drive users to take an action: to share/retweet the post, to click an attached link, or to respond and create a two-way conversation with an individual user. Rather than years' past where simple support for linked assets and coverage was provided, we'll need to better understand why the user would want this information and whether or not it commands an action, particularly whether or not it would invite them to respond to us. This puts responses and 1-to-1 conversations of much higher importance than we previously focused on.

To learn more about the specifics of engagement and conversations, check out our community management handbook page.

Elevation

Elevate our brand on social by delivering on intentional and properly planned campaigns with

cross-functional support to align with overall marketing OKRs. We'll look to polish visuals, write higher quality and shorter copy, and experiment with rich content like Twitter Spaces, livestreaming video, and other formats.

```
{{% alert title="What elevates our brand?" color="info" %}}  
<br> Results - we want an increase in engagement as well as the quality of our metrics  
<br> Emotional connections - we want to be able to say that we helped members of the community  
do better  
<br> Individual connections - 1-to-1 with the brand and our evangelists, to better develop  
GitLab champions  
<br> Polished look and feel - visuals and copy should resemble other big tech companies,  
refined and consistent messaging  
{{% /alert %}}
```

Elevation requires significant campaign planning, above years' past. The social team has already begun this work by developing a quarterly brief form and sync meeting program where the team connections with stakeholders across the marketing organization to better plan and understand critical campaigns.

Social Quarterly Brief Form

Remember when considering OKRs for organic social media

- It's about storytelling, not direct marketing
- Because our content goes worldwide and untargeted, organic social is top-of-funnel activity driving impressions, engagements, and conversations with assistance in link clicks to move users further down the funnel for the next team to work with
- The social team aids in corporate marketing OKRs as well as has our own to keep moving the practice at GitLab forward

Social Channels

```
| Channels under the care of the social team |  
| ----- |  
| GitLab Brand Twitter |  
| GitLab Brand LinkedIn |  
| GitLab Brand Facebook |  
| GitLab Brand Instagram |  
| GitLab Brand GIPHY Channel |
```

GitLab Branded Social Channels include our company Twitter, LinkedIn, and Facebook which are managed in a more traditional manner. And an Instagram channel that takes more of an editorial look at remote life and work at GitLab. This channel is a little less "marketing-y" and more about sharing thoughtful stories by our team members. Our GIPHY account is mainly for new GIF content, which can be tied to larger initiatives.

Content Pillars (FY23)

Our content pillars provide strategic direction for the social team and the GitLab team overall in terms of knowing what topics of content we should be investing in. Generally speaking,

organic social will want to play a role in each of these pillars, as we have seen good performance on related content in the last few years. Content pillars also make up the Pillar: xyz reporting tag in Sprout. This allows us to categorize and quantify performance across pillars. There may be periods where we do not have content for a specific pillar, not all pillars are active and scheduled all the time. However, the pillars guide our priorities and allow us to shift attention as needed. Some content may straddle several pillars.

- All Remote Brand
- Blog
- Developer Relations
- Corporate Events
- DevOps Leadership
- Press / News
- Product
- Talent Brand

A note on DevOps Leadership vs Product: Product pillar is only about GitLab the product. DevOps Leadership is more about perspective and point of view on the space, not necessarily about GitLab the product.

For more info on the Sprout tags for Pillars, refer to the Reporting Handbook page.

Only the social team can manage GitLab's social channels

Social media can be used as a relationship builder between GitLab and partners, vendors, event organizers, and other third parties. Leveraging GitLab's brand social media channels is a great way to extend these relationships further. However, only GitLab's brand social team has the authority to commit GitLab's brand social media channels for work. Please do not guarantee GitLab brand social media coverage to anyone without consulting and gaining approval from our team first. Our responsibility is to manage both our time as team members and the owned public image of our brand and product. These things are not taken into consideration unless the social team is actively a part of the conversation.

{{% alert color="warning" %}}

If you have committed GitLab's brand social media channels for social posts or committed the social team's time to projects before consulting with and gaining approval, the social team will reject the commitments.

{{% /alert %}}

Sharing 3rd-party events (onsite or virtual) on organic social where a team member is speaking

The purpose of GitLab team members participating in 3rd-party events is to bring GitLab's message to the 3rd-party's audience and to gain more community. Therefore, it's contradictory for GitLab brand social channels to promote a team member speaker for a 3rd-party event by default. Periodically, if the speaking engagement is part of a critical campaign or would resonate with the zeitgeist of the moment, we may tweet once for folks to register for the event. However, if you're the speaker, we encourage you to post to your own social channels so that your network can join the event. Share your post with the socialmedia Slack channel and we'll like, comment, and maybe share your post!

Sharing blog posts

New blogs are linked in the content-updates channel, and then our team uses that as a notification that the blog is ready to schedule and share on social. Sometimes when it's connected to a campaign or is particularly important, we'll also get a ping about it in a thread from the original slack message.

If the blog is connected to an integrated campaign, it will be picked up in the social issues and epics for that campaign. If it is a part of a press release/announcement, we'll also be tagged in related issues through the PR workflow.

On a quarterly basis the social media team will identify the best performing blogs. The top 2-3 blogs will then be reintroduced and scheduled to publish on GitLab's Brand Social Channels.

Check out the blog content workflow for social on our admin page

Sharing monthly releases

In addition to the existing workflow with the release team, we should look to share the news with all of GitLab. Following the scheduling/publishing of our brand posts for the release, add the release post as a story to Bambu/Advocacy by Sprout. Once all links are available to share, respond to the message in whats-happening Slack channel and also send this message to the channel to for more awareness.

> You can share our release post on social media by either sharing our LinkedIn or Twitter posts or by sharing your own post via Bambu. You can also celebrate this month's MVP, [insert name], by selecting the copy in Bambu that highlights this month's winner.

Replace the italicized words above with links to their respective posts.

Sharing content from behind a paywall

We'll come across articles that are behind a pay wall from time to time, mainly when it's press coverage we're looking to share. We can still share these articles on our social channels, however, we'll need to disclose that there is a paywall in the copy of the social post, as to be transparent with our community. Clicks that come from folks who can't read the article aren't distinguishable from clicks where folks can read below the fold, so it's important to be clear about the differences.

Add the paywall disclosure copy to the very end of the copy. Consider using a line break to make this sentence explicit to the community.

text

This article is behind a paywall.

Support and status communications on social media

For GitLab status updates, folks can find info at the @gitlabstatus Twitter handle. This account is not managed by the social team.

Beyond general inquiries and regular social engagement with our followers, we do not provide core support in private messages on social channels. We will instead direct followers to the GitLab forums for support.

Please use a derivative of this message:

text

Thanks for reaching out! In our spirit of transparency, we don't provide support here. Please add your question to the Q&A section of the GitLab forum, so that everyone can learn the answer. <https://forum.gitlab.com/c/questions-and-answers/7>

Calendaring and content volume

We know that less is more, usually. However GitLab is a global all remote brand. We have users in every timezone and we are often organizing events and news to coordinate in ways that include people across the globe. Because of this, our calendaring and volume must remain adaptable.

Content calendars are often at "full capacity" or what we'd consider:

- 1-2x on LinkedIn per day
- 1-2x on Facebook per day
- 2-4x on Twitter per day

This is due to the sheer volume of content that we'd deem as valuable to our audiences, the need to continue driving traffic to our website, and to continuously include followers across timezones on our social channels. However, we will ultimately publish content at the best times of day, determined by Sprout machine learning, which may or may not include a wide variety of times.

Our "full capacity" concept is not a requirement. We can and will evolve our calendaring volume and focuses as brand, community, and business needs change. If this does change, we'll need to establish proper expectations.

Channel Use

Twitter

Because the wider developer community utilizes Twitter as a platform to celebrate contributions, make feature suggestions, and share industry ideas, GitLab prioritizes this channel. We post to this platform first, and also more frequently.

On Twitter our GitLab community is our first priority. It includes those who contribute to our DevOps platform, our GitLab Heroes, and folks who evangelize the industry. We take time to listen to their feedback, even when it is critical. We make space for fun. Through inside jokes, polls, or simple questions, our Twitter channel provides developers an opportunity to take a break and relate to one another. GitLab's Twitter community is unique because we focus on engaging with their opinions. And delivering them tailored content they will actually find useful, or inspiring.

The GitLab Brand Twitter channel is establishing a sense of community through these activities:

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Posting frequently

</summary>

Twitter does not operate like our other GitLab Social Branded Channels. There are no strict frequency limitations on Twitter and we aim to post at a minimum of 3 times a day if not more. Retweets and quote tweets scheduled to the calendar do not reduce our limitation. We see 1:1 interactions as useful, limitless, and should always be added to the calendar if they correlate with a promotion, or simply celebrate a milestone. Every post should take advantage of Sprout's optimal time feature as we have many followers located across all time zones.

Do not always select the 3-5 stars optimal time. If there are already 4 posts going out that day select the 1-2 stars optimal time. This will help keep the calendar properly spaced out and ensure we have content publishing throughout the day.

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Community management

</summary>

GitLab's Twitter ecosystem of engagement includes mentions from code contributors, brand personalities, technical evangelists, GitLab Heroes, remote work enthusiasts, and team members. We prioritize engaging with these audiences because it enables the brand to drive more meaningful interactions through social media. That means we use the Smart Inbox feature to find posts to like, comment, or retweet on a daily basis. We commit to quote tweeting posts when someone shares their MyFirstMRmerged, a contribution to a project, or excitement about a new feature.

GitLab also participates in periodic giveaways which are launched directly on our Twitter channel. The barrier to entry often includes a social share and tag. Our audience has responded really well to these easy-to-enter giveaways that provide them free passes or swag items. We believe in these 1:1 relationships that we've built online. It feels good to give back to our community who makes us a loveable product, and brand.

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Storytelling

</summary>

We're human. And enable humans to build better software, together. So to share our stories with the world, we don't just quickly share a piece of content. We develop organic social media campaigns that have our audience and their reactions in mind. We take a corporate blog- and craft it into an editorial campaign. We display real voices through creative imagery. We share relatable experiences, and bring light to specific features that make DevOps- easier. We don't share headlines- we develop a deeper understanding.

</details>

<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
Polls & Questions
</summary>

Creating space to interact with the GitLab community has always been a priority for our Twitter channel. By posting frequent polls, or questions- we found a way to increase engagement and also generate two way conversation. We ask a variety of questions, both silly and thought-provoking.

<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
Emoji & GIF use
</summary>

Our tone of voice on social media is human and friendly. All devs are friends; no matter the tool they use. That's why we use emoji whenever we can. The overuse of emoji allows us to participate in a universally used language. GitLab believes that everyone can contribute. That's why being better communicators is crucial for our audience- no message should go misunderstood.

When the opportunity presents itself, using GIFs in quote tweets, comments, or celebratory posts has proven to increase engagement.

LinkedIn

Our LinkedIn community consumes content over conversation, first. Though there are opportunities to drive conversation related to company culture, remote work, and exciting announcements. GitLab's LinkedIn page strategically keeps our followers reading, and spending time on our blogs, releases, topic pages, and use cases. Ultimately, we use LinkedIn as an opportunity to expand in more detail on the content we care about. How do we do that? By using a variety of formatted posts with more thoughtful text, questions, polls, quotes, or even statistics. Due to the nature of the platform, there is less 1:1 conversation, and engagement with the community. We also have a decreased frequency of posts in comparison to our Twitter channel. How often GitLab should post on LinkedIn depends on the time of year, and the content we are sharing. Typically we post every single day, and up to 2 times per day. However, we do make exceptions for special events, and major brand-level campaigns.

The GitLab Brand LinkedIn channel is establishing GitLab as the complete DevOps platform through these activities:

<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
Posting consciously
</summary>

LinkedIn does not operate like Twitter. We publish two posts per day with the exception of timely announcements that must take place. Content shared should prioritize our culture, blog,

releases, remote work, and press mentions. Because there is a limited post frequency, every post published should be during Sprout Social's 5 star and 4 star optimal times. This will ensure the few posts we share, are seen by followers located across all time zones.

By posting consciously, we don't just consider the time a post goes live. When the social media team is supporting brand-level campaigns or majors events like Commit or KubeCon. It is important to include content that supports the wider marketing organization's OKR's. That means if there is a Pathfactory link available, the social media manager should direct folks there first.

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Evangelizing our values

</summary>

Though LinkedIn doesn't function like Twitter, you can strategically encourage opinions with thought provoking and also relatable content. For example, in this post we normalized the celebration of gray squares in your contribution chart. This started a very transparent and honest discussion about the hours people work, the days they contribute on, and also don't. When publishing content centered around our GitLab values, the social media manager always responds to comments thoughtfully and intentionally to create a stronger connection to our brand.

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Responding as the company

</summary>

It is important to amplify partner mentions, contributors and their wins, and GitLab team members' channels when the social media manager sees fit. So if there is an exciting partnership that announces a new integration, a hackathon winner, or even a "we belong here" story- these are all great examples that should be engaged with or shared directly to our company page on LinkedIn. Please see this section of the handbook for instructions on how to do that.

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Press mentions

</summary>

Promoting GitLab as a thought leader, and loveable brand has always been a priority for Social @ GitLab. By sharing third-party content or press mentions, we increase engagement and impressions on LinkedIn. For example, in this post GitLab is named one of the Best Workplaces 2021 and was a top post by engagement. The social media team should monitor the external-comms channel to find more opportunities.

</details>

Facebook

The reality is that GitLab has a smaller audience on Facebook so its priority does fall below our efforts on Twitter and LinkedIn. It is still important to maintain a presence on this channel because it provides folks basic information about our business, and proves to still see organic reach. That said, there is a decreased frequency for this channel. And social media team also chooses not to share certain types of campaigns to this channel as it is not the right audience.

The GitLab Brand Facebook channel is reinforces our presence as a lovable brand through these activities:

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Posting occasionally

</summary>

We aim to post once a day on Facebook to maintain a presence and our social media landscape. though, there is no immediate need to post every single day on Facebook. If content is not available, then a post does not need to publish that day. During heavy calendaring times- there should be no more than 2 posts a day on Facebook. Organic Facebook posts can cannibalize ROI from other organic posts, so a high frequency of posts will inevitably have a lower reach per post. This tactic should only be used during critical times meaning for timely announcements, or news that requires more than one post that day.

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Tailoring content

</summary>

Facebook content should prioritize the following: company culture, remote work, our community, values, features, and announcements.

Campaigns that require you to sign up will not see success on this channel, and should only be published on Twitter and LinkedIn.

</details>

Instagram

In no way shape or form should our Instagram account mirror our other GitLab Branded Social Channels. In fact, it takes more of an editorial approach to it, and is less "marketing-y" and more about building community.

Since launching the GitLab Brand Instagram channel the Social Media Team committed to posting weekly content driven by a dedicated theme which represents our values, remote work, or life at

GitLab.

FY22Q1: We Belong Here

FY22H1: Cribs

Future themes TBD

The GitLab Brand Instagram channel reinforces us as an all-remote organization that really awesome humans want to work for through these activities:

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Posting weekly

</summary>

We aim to post once a week on Instagram to maintain a steady and ever increasing follower growth. Being consistent with your frequency will avoid seeing a drop in engagement and give folks a reason to follow. It also increases the chance of our content being discovered.

Because we only post once a week on this channel, it should always be scheduled during the most optimal time according to Sprout Social. Note that if you are scheduling more than one photo per post, you will have to publish natively through the Sprout Social app. Here are instructions on how to do that.

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Instagram Stories

</summary>

The stories feature on Instagram should be used to extend the life of the feed post you shared that week. After engagement on the post has slowed, use the story feature on Instagram. The story does not have to replicate your recent post. Instead it increases reach and visits to the Brand Instagram channel.

</details>

<details>

<summary markdown='span'>

Storytelling

</summary>

We want to share real-life stories and experiences with our Instagram community to create a stronger connection with them. We use the caption as an opportunity to share a voice of a GitLab team member who is living our values. We extend the employer brand and incite fun conversation around remote working.

</details>

<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
 Respond to comments
</summary>

The GitLab Instagram channel should really feel human. That's why you should respond to every single comment that isn't from an automated bot. Even a simple emoji, or like can go a long way. It reinforces the connection to our brand.

</details>

<details>
<summary markdown='span'>
 Hashtags and account tags
</summary>

Each campaign/theme executed on the Instagram Brand Channel should include hashtag research, and specific hashtags to use at launch. By using strategic hashtags, and tagging specific accounts, your post will be seen beyond the feed. You will increase your chances of being discovered in Instagram's Explore page. The Instagram Explore page has an algorithm that improves content recommendations. Here are instructions on how to do that.

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YouTube

The social media team does not manage GitLab's YouTube presence. Please reach out to Brand Video Team using the brandvideo Slack channel.

Social Media Design

We look to the design team to provide integrated campaign assets and elements to use on social, many rapid design needs are fulfilled from the social team directly by Using Canva Pro. Canva Pro provides the social team with an easy-to-use tool on any device to quickly spin up designs. Social Media requires rapid responses and quick turnarounds, so to do we require the same of our designs.

While Canva does provide many pre templated layouts, we do not use those. The social team will build custom art using basic GitLab brand guidelines and best practices for social media. In the future, many templates and individual assets will be brand team approved, but we have not iterated far enough to work in a rapid process.

The elements the social team uses for our designs are mainly GitLab-owned. Icons, sketches, animations, etc. were usually created for non-social purposes and we've added them to our library to use for social media. We do use Pro-only elements on occasion, but strive to find elements we feel would not be used often by other brands.

Social image sizes

While each channel has their own best sizes to use, and changes often, for the sake of scale

and efficiency, we'll use the following dimensions unless otherwise noted.

- 1800 x 945 for Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn, and about.gitlab.com embedded social sharing cards (or.opengraphs)
- 1620 x 1620 for Instagram wall posts (unless we are deliberately using IG's vertical or horizontal options)
- 1620 x 2880 for stories (vertical) posts on any channel that supports stories

<details><summary>Here's the strategy behind the decisions above</summary>

- Images in the dimensions of 1800 x 945 are currently visible correctly across Facebook, LinkedIn, and Twitter. In some instances, the images are a bit off-center on Twitter's mobile app, however, the majority of our audience engages with us via desktop, which puts our visual strategies into a desktop-first experience. They are also the correct size for.opengraph cards. This may change in the future, as channels continue to tweak how their sites show images.

- The specific pixel size of these images should be larger than what is advertised (e.g. every image standard above is 1.5x the recommended pixel size). This is because each channel has its own way of processing images that are uploaded to the site, and in many cases, a larger image results in a higher quality visual when either downsampled (reduced quality) or shrunk to fit (the larger size is seen smaller, making the image sharper).

</details>

Social Videos

Each social channel can have videos uploaded directly to them. We can use videos as we see fit, but they will need to follow the following guidelines:

- 16:9 or 1:1 ratio
- less than 2 minutes and 20 seconds required; though performance increases with shorter, snappier videos
- min. of 720 resolution, preferably 1080 or 2k to account for high resolution screens
- burned in subtitles or an.srt file if there are any voices speaking in the video (this is requirement and videos are not usable without subtitles)
- video title
- no long intro or outro - the content needs to begin within the first 3 seconds of the video

Social du